Polaris Workforce — Pricing Strategies

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Summary

Price Polaris per active worker per month, with a monthly minimum, plan-gated features and a setup fee. That mix could bring in about **53 M XOF (≈80,000 €) in year 3** with 50 paying construction firms.

- **Market assumed:** francophone West Africa. Prices are in XOF, with euros at the fixed rate of 1 € = 655.957 XOF.
- **Main driver:** the number of customers. Each medium customer (150 workers) is worth about 1.1–1.3 M XOF (≈1,900 €) a year.
- **Status of the numbers:** these are working assumptions, not market data. Check them with prospects before you fix prices.

What the customer gets back

A 3% cut in payroll losses saves a mid-size firm about **675,000 XOF a month**. So a price of 70,000–135,000 XOF a month (10–20% of that saving) is an easy sale.

Item	Value
Daily workers	150
Day wage	6,000 XOF
Working days a month	25
Monthly payroll	22.5 M XOF (≈34,000 €)
Saving at 3% less loss (ghost workers, padded headcounts, pay disputes)	675,000 XOF a month

Lead the sale with this saving, not with features.

Customer base used for the comparison

Every strategy below is applied to the same 50 companies, a plausible base after 2–3 years: 7,200 workers on 135 sites.

Size	Companies	Workers each	Sites each
Small	25	40	1
Medium	18	150	3
Large	7	500	8

Pricing strategies compared

Per site brings in the most on paper (≈65 M XOF a year), but per worker is fairer and tracks the value each customer gets. Yearly revenue is for the 50-company base above.

Strategy	Example price	Yearly revenue	Strengths	Weaknesses
Per active site per month	40,000 XOF per site	≈64.8 M XOF (≈99,000 €)	Matches how builders budget: the cost goes to the project.	Expensive for small firms. Customers may merge sites in the app to pay less.
Per active worker per month (workers on at least one roll call that month)	800 XOF per worker for the first 100, 500 beyond; minimum 25,000 XOF	≈55.8 M XOF (≈85,000 €)	Grows with the customer's payroll. Fair for seasonal crews.	Bills change month to month. Large firms push for discounts.
Fixed plans	Starter 25,000 XOF (1 site, up to 30 workers); Pro 90,000 XOF (up to 5 sites, 200 workers); Enterprise from 250,000 XOF (presence tracking, Claude/MCP, API)	≈47.9 M XOF (≈73,000 €)	Simple to sell and to budget for.	Leaves money on the table with firms near the top of a plan.

Strategy	Example price	Yearly revenue	Strengths	Weaknesses
One-time licence + yearly maintenance, customer hosts it (large firms only)	6 M XOF up front + 20% a year	42 M XOF in year 1, then 8.4 M a year (7 large firms)	A lot of cash early. Suits public-works contractors who want their data in-house.	Over 3 years ≈59 M XOF, against ≈71 M on a subscription. Revenue comes in lumps.
Share of payroll paid by mobile money (add-on, with a licensed payment partner)	Net share of about 0.4% of wages paid	≈20.7 M XOF (≈32,000 €) if 40% of payroll moves off cash	Grows on its own with payroll.	E-money is regulated, so it needs a partner. Polaris handles cash only today. Workers resist fees.
Extras on top of any strategy	Setup and foreman training 150,000–1.5 M XOF; BLE badges at a margin; priority support	≈20 M XOF one-time across 50 customers	Pays for on-site onboarding.	Not recurring.

Recommended model

Combine per-worker pricing with plan features, a setup fee and a discount for paying a year ahead.

- **Base price:** per active worker per month, with a monthly minimum of about 25,000 XOF.
- **Higher plans unlock:** presence tracking (GPS and BLE badges), the Claude/MCP integration, multi-company and the API.
- **Setup fee:** pays for training foremen on site and importing workers.
- **Yearly prepay discount:** late B2B payment is the main risk in this market.
- **Mobile-money payouts later:** an extra income line once a payment partner is signed.
- **How to sell:** a free one-month pilot on one site. Show the gap between the headcount the firm expected and the one the roll call confirmed.

Revenue path and take-home

With the recommended model, revenue grows from about 10 M XOF in year 1 to about 53 M XOF in year 3.

Year	Paying customers at year end	Recurring revenue	Setup fees	Total
1	10	~6 M XOF	~4 M XOF	~10 M XOF (≈15,000 €)
2	30	~22 M XOF	~8 M XOF	~30 M XOF (≈46,000 €)
3	50	~45 M XOF	~8 M XOF	~53 M XOF (≈80,000 €)

Recurring revenue is lower than the customer count suggests because customers sign up during the year.

Revenue is not take-home pay. Hosting is cheap: one small server running SQLite serves many companies. The real costs are people:

- an onboarding and support person who trains foremen on site (≈300,000–400,000 XOF a month);
- transport;
- taxes;
- your own time spent selling.

Expect to keep roughly 50–70% of revenue from about 30 customers onward, and much less before that.

Assumptions to check and next steps

The biggest unknowns are how much payroll firms lose today and how fast you can sign customers. Replace these assumptions with real answers:

Assumption	Value used
Payroll lost to ghost workers and disputes, recovered by Polaris	3%
Day wage	6,000 XOF
Share of payroll moving to mobile money	40%

Assumption	Value used
Customers signed	10, 30, 50 by the end of years 1, 2, 3
Average setup fee	400,000 XOF

- [ ] Interview 5–10 construction firms: daily payroll, how they check headcount today, what they would pay to stop losing money.
- [ ] Run one free pilot on one site and measure the headcount gap.
- [ ] Talk to a licensed mobile-money aggregator about payout fees and revenue share.
- [ ] Fix the price list after the interviews and the pilot.

Selling in Europe or North America could support prices 5–10 times higher, against established competitors.